

Eclipse in Action

The author takes readers through an in-depth tutorial on how to use Eclipse in programming.

Eclipse is an integrated development environment (IDE) that is used in programming, and is one of the most widely used Java IDEs. One of its strengths is its extensible plugin system for customisation. Table 1 lists the features of Eclipse.

Let's now look at how to download and install Eclipse.

Download and installation

Eclipse can be downloaded from <https://www.eclipse.org/downloads/>.

Find the section called *Get Eclipse IDE 2019-09*. Click on *Download*. The default mirror site will be available, such as 'Download from: Japan - Japan Advanced Institute of Science and Technology (http)'. We can click on *Select Another Mirror* as well. Click on *Download* again. Next, click on the installer file. For Windows, it will be *eclipse-inst-win64.exe* (the 64-bit version).

Let us now select 'Eclipse IDE for Enterprise Java Developers'. This will pick up Java 1.8+ and the installation

folder on its own. Then click on *Install*.

Step 1: Review and accept licences before Eclipse can be installed. All Eclipse downloads are provided under 'Terms and conditions' of the 'Eclipse Foundation Software User Agreement' unless specified otherwise.

Step 2: Click on *Accept*. The installation of packages will continue.

Step 3: Another dialogue box will appear, named 'Accept Trusted Certificates'. Select the certificates available and click on *Accept Selected Certificates*.

Table 1: All about Eclipse

Latest stable release	4.13(2019-09 R) / 18 September
Programming languages supported	Ada, ABAP, C, C++, C#, COBOL, Erlang, Fortran, Groovy, JavaScript, NATURAL, Perl, PHP, Prolog, Python, R, Ruby, Rust, Scala, etc.
Written in	Java and others
Operating systems supported	Windows, Linux, MacOS, Solaris
Version names	Callisto, Europa, Ganymede, Galileo, Helios, Indigo, Juno, Kepler, Luna, Mars, Neon, Oxygen, Photon, 2018-09, 2018-12, 2019-03, 2019-06, 2019-09, 2019-12
Open source	Yes
Licence	Eclipse Public Licence
Website	www.eclipse.org
To show all shortcut keys	Ctrl + Shift + L
To list parameter help	Ctrl + Shift + Space
To organise the import statement in a Java program	Ctrl + Shift + O
Indentations	Ctrl + i
Debug	F11
Run	Ctrl + F11